

Four foundational principles of Agile

Agile helps teams create value faster by keeping the end user at the center, working collaboratively, delivering continuously, and learning through experimentation.

01 Focus on end users

Connect early with users (internal or external) to gain insights and develop solutions that truly fit their needs. Use design thinking methods such as user personas and user journey mapping.



Real user insights lead to better solutions



02 Be team-oriented

Work in small, cross-functional teams with clear roles and shared ownership. The team is responsible for the solution and empowered to make decisions, with fewer layers of approval and roadblocks.

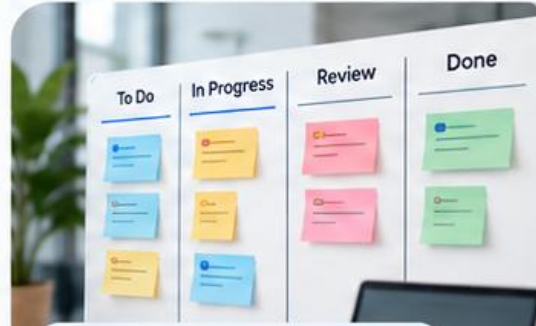


Empowered teams move faster



03 Deliver continuous value

Focus on the end goal and deliver value in small increments through iterative development. Continuously gather user feedback to measure success and make improvements.



Small increments create real impact



04 Experiment and learn quickly

Use short, test-and-learn cycles (sprints) to validate ideas, reduce risk, and continuously improve. Stay flexible and be ready to adapt based on what you learn.



Test early, learn faster

From insights to impact, through continuous iteration

Putting it all together

Digital is the combination of data, technology and ways of working. These ingredients help both individuals and organizations automate, connect, innovate and make better decisions.

More and more organizations are 'going digital' and looking for individuals who have both the skills and mindsets to learn and work in such environments.

From the perspective of modern organizations, digital is the best way to better meet the needs and enhance the experience of customers and employees.



To see how all the different components of digital come together, next you'll see how one manufacturer transformed its business through digital.



From Equipment to Intelligence

John Deere shifted from selling machines to helping farmers make better decisions with data.



A growing challenge for agriculture

As the global population rises, the agricultural industry needs to grow more food on limited land while reducing costs and improving sustainability.



A legacy of innovation

John Deere was founded almost 200 years ago to make and sell farm equipment.



A strategic shift

In recent years, company leaders realized that selling more of the same equipment would not help farmers do more with less. They changed their strategy to integrate advanced technologies into farm vehicles, enabling farmers' longer-term success.



THE SHIFT

From selling equipment to enabling outcomes.



1



Understand farmers

Gain a deeper understanding of farmers' needs, challenges, and their customers.

2



Connect technology & data

Integrate advanced technologies into farm vehicles and make data more accessible and useful.

3



Enable better decisions

Give farmers simpler ways to collect, understand, and use data to improve their outcomes.

Turning Data into Better Decisions

John Deere integrated advanced technologies into its farm equipment to give farmers real-time insights and practical recommendations.



01

Collecting the right data

The company added sensors to its machines that analyzed weather forecasts and data on soil conditions, seed properties, and other information critical to farmers' day-to-day decisions.



02

Creating real impact for farmers

John Deere combined cameras, cloud technology, and artificial intelligence. Data from smart cameras was automatically uploaded to the cloud, where farmers could evaluate crop quality in real time and collaborate with other farmers to get advice on what to plant and where, how much fertilizer to use, and so on. As the machines gathered more data, more farmers benefited, allowing the company to use AI and machine learning to find previously unseen patterns and improve their products.

Take a moment to reflect, why was John Deere successful?

Select all that apply.



Challenged current constraints



Embraced iterations



Sought new opportunities



Focused on the need of the farmer



All of the above



All of the above!

The solution was only possible because John Deere challenged current constraints, embraced iterations, and sought out new opportunities to focus on the needs of farmers. The company developed the technology to capture and analyze data and built equipment that farmers needed. The new strategy enabled farmers to produce more food more efficiently.

Your Digital Toolkit and Plan

Now that you have explored the different factors driving digital transformation, take time to reflect on your own digital journey and create a plan for what you want to do next.



"Today's reflection is the foundation for your progress tomorrow."



Take a moment to reflect and write your answers to the questions below. This reflection will help you personalize your learning and clarify which areas you want to explore further.

1



What have you already done

to expand your knowledge and skills in this area?

Write your answer here...

2



What is an obstacle you currently face

in understanding or taking action in this area?

Write your answer here...

3



Identify 1 or more specific actions

you want to take to enhance your knowledge and skills in this area.

Write your answer here...

4



Prioritize one action you will start immediately

and specify a timeline for it.

Write your answer here...

Key takeaways

In this module, we have covered the following key tools.



Data

Turning information into insights



Technology

Enabling new possibilities



New ways of working

Rethinking how we collaborate and create value



MAIN TAKEAWAY

Use the three components of digital — data, technology, and new ways of working — to shape your thinking and define your own digital toolkit for the opportunities ahead.

You may also wish to explore



What's the future of the internet?

Explore Web3, tokenization, prompt engineering, digital-twin technology, quantum computing, proof of stake, blockchain.

[Future of Tech](#)[McKinsey & Company](#)

What is generative AI?

Key trends, use cases, and what it means for business and society.

[Generative AI](#)[McKinsey & Company](#)

Author Talks: Think Digital

Perspectives from McKinsey authors on navigating the digital era.

[Leadership](#)[McKinsey & Company](#)

Cloud as the ultimate digital enabler

Why cloud is foundational to digital transformation.

[Cloud](#)[McKinsey & Company](#)

Six digital trends gaining momentum— and why they matter

Key trends shaping the next wave of growth.

[Digital Trends](#)[McKinsey Blog](#)

How six companies are using technology and data to transform themselves

Real-world examples of digital transformation in action.

[Case Study](#)[McKinsey Digital](#)

Getting beyond gridlock in cities

How technology and data create more sustainable and livable cities.

[Sustainability](#)[McKinsey Sustainability](#)

The most fundamental skill: Intentional learning and the career advantage

Why continuous learning is essential in the digital era.

[Career Growth](#)[McKinsey Quarterly](#)

Seven essential elements of a lifelong-learning mindset

Practical ways to build a growth mindset.

[Mindset](#)[McKinsey Quarterly](#)

AI in Action: An interactive learning journey

Explore real-world applications of AI through an interactive experience.

[Interactive](#)[McKinsey & Company](#)

Closing Remarks

A stronger digital mindset today opens bigger opportunities tomorrow.

IN SUMMARY

In this course, **you have learned how to:**

01



Identify different types of digital advancements

and understand how they impact you—your work, your industry, and your future opportunities.

02



Develop your own digital toolkit

based on the knowledge and skills you want to explore further to support your personal and professional growth.



Looking ahead

We hope that you are excited about the opportunities within the digital world, and can continue to explore more as you progress in your career.